

choose the Reflection Center option and manually position it in the video in the Composition panel.

Click on the target symbol next to the Reflection Center under mirror in the Effect Controls panel and then manually click the center in the Composition panel. As soon as you do this, you can see the mirror effect in effect in the preview window.

Finally, preview the video by playing with the spacebar button. You will be able to see the both the effects in all their glory. First the video mirrors and you can see the reflection on one side and then at the one second mark, you can see the effect we had first used, 'the Fast Box Blur' Effect where the mirrored image slowly starts blurring out and this makes an elegant background for the logo to come into and for the logo text to fade into.

(Disclaimer: For some reason, I was not able to see the logo during this step and all the action was in the background, so don't be alarmed if you have a similar experience).

5) Exporting the Compositions

We have reached the end of our fun experiment trying to animate a logo and adding some visual effects. Almost. There's one final step left which is Exporting the Composition which will not keep it restricted for viewing only in After Effects but also make it more accessible outside.

The final step of bringing our animation to fruition is rendering the composition. This means taking the composition including effect settings, elements, layer order, etc. and processing it to make a viewable movie file.

In the AE menu, select Composition → Add to Render Queue. This means that it has been added to the queue but not yet rendered. Surprisingly, the timeline panel is replaced by the 'Render Queue' panel.

We need to check the export settings here before actually rendering.

Rendering is a whole other topic with a lot of options but for the sake of this tutorial, we will just use the most basic rendering setting. In the Render Queue panel, the APEAK_Logo composition should be the only item. There are 3 main sub-categories under our composition:

- a) Render Settings which have to be set to 'Best Settings'
- b) Output Module which has to be set to 'Lossless'.
- c) With the 'Output to' option (in the center of the panel), click on the blue text to determine the video's filename and location on your hard drive.

Once this is selected (the location), at the top right of the panel, a 'Render' button will appear (where previously, there was no such clickable button). Just click on it.